

Skills	Learners will be expected to demonstrate skills as defined in the Art and Design Core Content section of this specification, in the context of their chosen area(s) of Critical and Contextual Studies. In addition, learners will be required to demonstrate skills in all of the following: • selecting and using materials such as web-based research, gallery or site visits, books, journals, and other relevant resources • selecting, interpreting and scrutinising research material with the use of relevant subject terminology • understanding and using conventions when interpreting the impact/effect of social, religious and cultural contexts and local and global trends • undertaking critical analysis to ascertain and discuss appropriate historical, social and political contexts • analysing materials and techniques used by artists such as application of formal skills and construction techniques.
Knowledge and Understanding	Learners must use an appropriate range of processes and techniques using traditional and/or digital media, appropriate to the chosen subject area enabling research, exploration and the creation of final outcome(s) to include critical written and visual analysis. Learners will build and evidence an understanding of: • relevant technologies, materials, processes and resources • continuity and change in different genres, styles and traditions relevant to Critical and Contextual Studies and the chosen areas of study within this specialism • how ideas, feelings and meanings can be conveyed and interpreted in images and artefacts • how images and artefacts relate to the time and place in which they were made and to their social and cultural context • a working vocabulary and specialist terminology which are relevant to their chosen area(s) of study.